AEP FROM ZERO • PART 3 • PROVE WHAT WORKED (CJA)

EPISODE 26

CJA Data Views and Derived Fields Explained

What is a data view in Customer Journey Analytics (CJA), and how do CJA derived fields clean messy data without reloading a single row? This CJA data view tutorial walks the Configure, Containers, Components and Settings tabs, turns schema fields into metrics and dimensions, and explains component settings: attribution, count values versus count instances, persistence and the 30-minute session timeout. You will build five derived fields with Case When, Lowercase, URL Parse and Find and

Previously: Bloom 360 is connected

- Last time: Bloom 360 built, email as the person ID
- Stitching joined Priya's anonymous cart add to her order
- Use in CJA is a billing decision, not a view switch
- Today: the data view called Bloom Marketing
- Metrics, dimensions, sessions and five derived fields

KEY IDEA

Bloom 360 joins web, order and journey data on one person ID. Today the raw columns become numbers the whole team can trust.

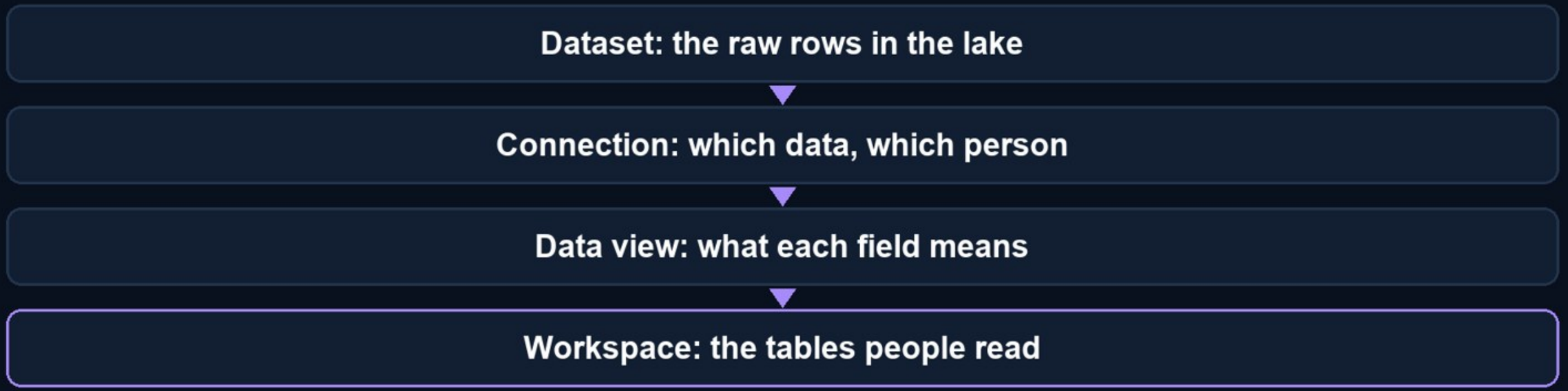
Orders or purchases? Naming decides trust

Raw column problem	What the data view decides
Orders or purchases?	One metric name, one meaning
email or Email?	One clean channel value
When does a visit end?	The session timeout
Which time zone is a day?	The calendar on Configure

KEY IDEA

Two teams using 'orders' and 'purchases' for different things can argue for months. One name, one meaning, written down, ends it.

What is a data view in CJA?



KEY IDEA

A data view sits on a connection and decides which fields become metrics and dimensions, what a session is and which time zone a day uses.

Configure: one name, one calendar

- Bloom 360's page: the button labelled Create data view
- Configure: Connection, Name, External ID
- Calendar: time zone, calendar type, first month and day
- AJO reports run in UTC; a data view can differ
- Mistake: two time zones, two answers for one day

KEY IDEA

Configure holds the connection, the name and the calendar. A report's day starts at midnight in the data view's time zone.

Containers and the 30-minute session

Container	A Bloom question it answers
Person, shown as People	How many customers bought?
Session	How many visits ended in an order?
Event	How many orders were placed?
Session timeout	30 minutes with no activity ends it

KEY IDEA

Containers are the levels you count at: person, session and event. A session ends after 30 minutes with no activity.

Metrics, dimensions, and one field many ways

Bloom Marketing metrics	Bloom Marketing dimensions
Orders	Marketing channel
Revenue	Product category, from the lookup
Cart adds	Loyalty band
Journey entries	Journey name
Product views	Order value band

KEY IDEA

Drag a schema field into Metrics to count it, or into Dimensions to split by it. One field can back several metrics with different settings.

Count values vs count instances in CJA

Behavior setting	What it adds	Priya's order
Count values	The number in the field	54 dollars
Count instances	One per row	1 order
Wrong one on Revenue	Rows, not money	Revenue reads 1

KEY IDEA

Count values adds the number in the field. Count instances adds one per row. One order total field can back both Revenue and Orders.

Attribution and persistence defaults

- Attribution: which touch gets the credit
- Last Touch is the usual default; models in episode 29
- Persistence, dimensions only: how long a value sticks
- Deduplication: first occurrence per person or session
- Mistake: changing a default to fix one report

KEY IDEA

A metric's attribution setting is the default credit rule for everyone. Persistence keeps a dimension value attached to later events.

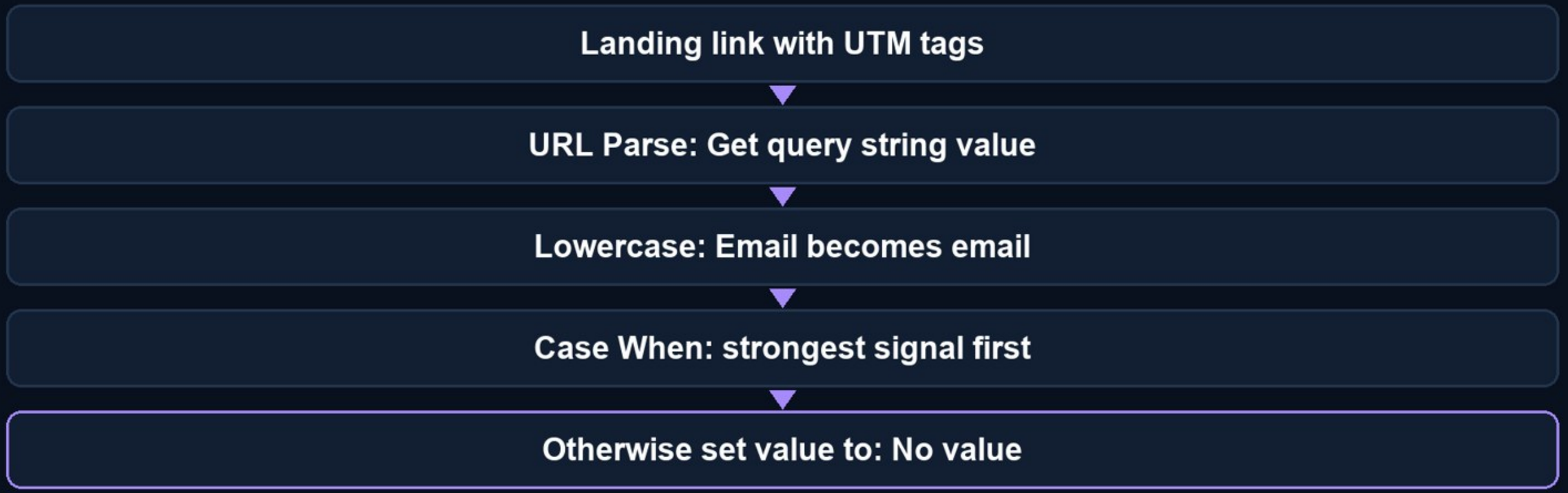
What are derived fields in CJA?

- Report-time logic, not ingest-time logic
- Retroactive: last year's rows are cleaned too
- Data view, Components tab, Create derived field
- 18 functions and 19 templates, as of 2026
- Final output previews the last 30 days

KEY IDEA

A derived field is report-time logic built from other fields. It cleans, combines or creates values, and it fixes past data too, with no reload.

Derived field one: the marketing channel



KEY IDEA

Bloom's channel comes from links and UTM tags. URL Parse reads the tag, Lowercase merges 'email' and 'Email', and Case When names the channel.

Four more: value, journey, abandon, loyalty

Derived field	The rule in plain words
Average order value band	Band each order by its total
Journey name, cleaned	Find and Replace strips the version
Abandoned flag	A cart add with no order after it
Loyalty band	Case When on points, Gold first

KEY IDEA

An average order value band, a cleaned journey name, an abandoned flag and a loyalty band. Each rule is written in plain words and tested on Priya.

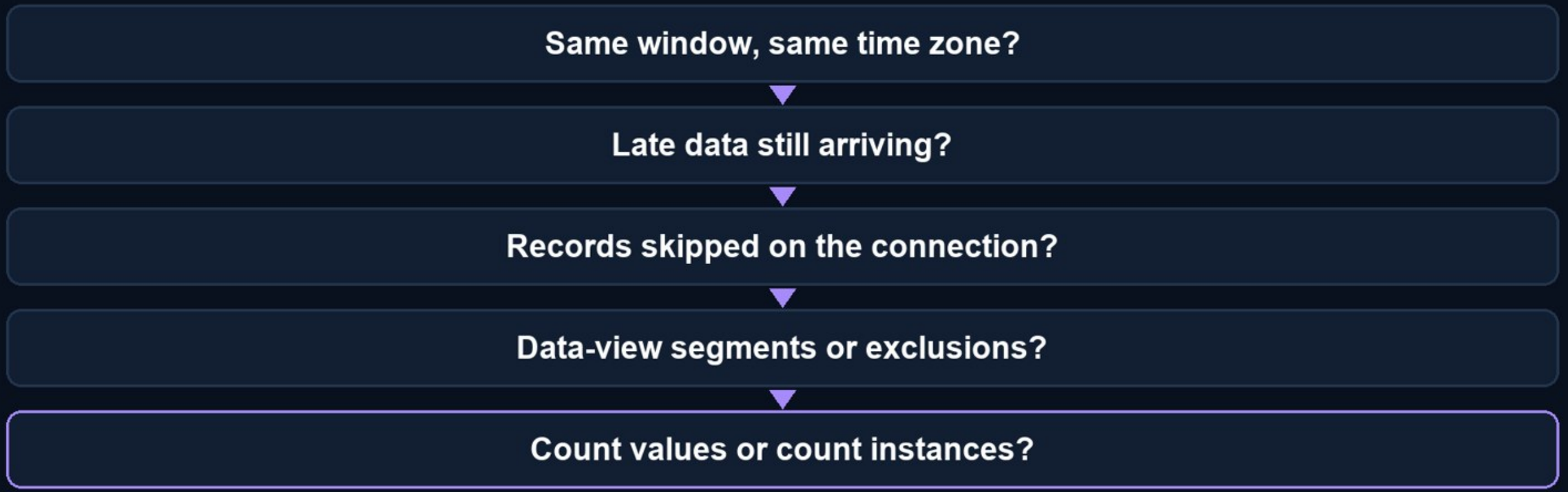
A derived field belongs to the connection

- Derived fields live at the connection level
- Edit one in any data view: every data view changes
- Saved under Schema fields, in a Derived fields group
- Give each one an owner and a description
- Practise only where nobody else depends on it

KEY IDEA

Derived fields live at the connection level. Change one in any data view and it changes in every data view on Bloom 360.

Reconcile the totals against the source



KEY IDEA

Before anyone reads a chart, compare data-view totals with the source dataset for the same window, and explain every gap.

Interview corner

- Data view: where a raw column becomes a trusted number
- Four tabs: Configure, Containers, Components, Settings
- Count values versus count instances, on one field
- Derived fields: report-time, retroactive, connection-wide
- Reconcile against the source before any chart

KEY IDEA

A data view is where a raw column becomes a number someone can trust, and a derived field fixes last year's data without a reload.

Recap, your question, and Anjali's five

- Data view: four tabs, one trusted meaning per metric
- Containers: person, session, event; 30-minute timeout
- Count values adds the number; instances add one per row
- Derived fields fix the past and belong to the connection
- Next: Anjali's five questions, your first Workspace

KEY IDEA

Data views give meaning, component settings decide counting, derived fields clean the past.
Next: Anjali's five questions in Workspace.